

## MB 403: French

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| Course Code       | MB 403                                                                            |
| Course Name       | French                                                                            |
| L-T-P-C           | 3-0-0-3                                                                           |
| Prerequisites     | NA                                                                                |
| Intended for      | Integrated MBA                                                                    |
| Mutual Exclusion  | HS 591                                                                            |
| One-time approval | 59th BoA (Apr 2025), in the Integrated MBA (IMBA) curriculum; 65th BoA (Aug 2026) |

### Preamble

This course introduces complete beginners (CEFR A0) to French for business and everyday communication, bringing them to a solid elementary level (CEFR A1) by the end of the semester. It strengthens the four core competences: listening, speaking, reading and writing, through practical situations such as professional introductions, company descriptions, meetings, everyday transactions and short written messages. Priority is given to oral practice, through role-plays, short presentations and practical cases, to build confidence in real professional and everyday exchanges, while introducing the social and cultural codes (forms of address, greetings) of a French-speaking context.

### Course Modules

- **Unit 1: The Basics:** (12 hours)
  - Introduction to French pronunciation and the alphabet; greetings and politeness formulas; the tu/vous distinction and basic social codes (handshake vs. bises); self-introductions (name, nationality, profession, contact details, spelling one's name).
  - Numbers, prices, telling the time, days of the week and months, and expressions of time used for schedules and daily/work routines.
  - Present tense of être, avoir and the pronominal verbs, of regular -er verbs, and of the most frequent irregular verbs; basic sentence structure; simple negation (ne... pas); asking questions (est-ce que, qu'est-ce que, où, quand, combien), near future and near past.
  - Describing colleagues or classmates, family, company departments, and one's academic background (field of study, courses, campus life), useful vocabulary for a CV profile or an admission interview.
- **Unit 2: Listening and Comprehension Skills:** (10 hours)
  - Understanding simple everyday and workplace instructions and directions (an office, a campus, a pharmacy, a bank).
  - Identifying key information and main points from short audio-visual clips related to companies, studies abroad and everyday situations.
  - Close listening exercises with everyday and professional dialogues (a business phone call, renting a room, opening a bank account, a doctor's or pharmacy visit, a restaurant order).
  - Reading and comprehension activities with short everyday and business documents (a lease or housing ad, a bank form, a menu, an email, a class schedule).
- **Unit 3: Speaking Skills:** (10 hours)
  - Identifying and practising intonation patterns in polite everyday and professional exchanges (requests, questions, confirmations).
  - Ordering food and drinks at a café or restaurant, and asking for and giving simple directions using the imperative (tournez, continuez, prenez la rue...).
  - Role-playing everyday and professional scenarios: exchanging business cards at a networking event, a short job or admission interview, renting accommodation, opening a bank account, a pharmacy visit, etc.
  - Short presentations introducing oneself, one's studies or company, and stating simple upcoming plans (aller + infinitive).
- **Unit 4: Writing Skills:** (4 hours)
  - Writing short sentences with core grammatical structures (question and answer, affirmation and negation, near future and near past) in everyday and professional contexts.
  - Writing short everyday and professional messages: an introductory email, a housing or appointment request, and a simple form (registration, bank, CV profile).

### Laboratory Modules

NA

### Text Books

1. *Edito A1, methode de francais*, editions Didier, 2016.
2. *Travailler en entreprise*, Editions Didier, 2009.

### References

1. *Cours de Langue et de Civilisation Francais* by G. Mauger.
2. *Dondo Modern French Course* by M Ferlin.
3. Jean Benoit, Nicholas Rollin, *The Oxford Hachette French Dictionary*, Oxford University Press, 2007.